STANDARDS FOR LANGUAGE

The speaking in Public speaking…

We all know what language is, right?



Clear language is powerful language. Meaning that clarity (the essence of being clear) should be your first concern as a public speaker when it comes to choosing how to phrase the ideas of your speech.

If you are not clear, specific, precise, and detailed with your language, you won't be understood.

There are many aspects of clarity in language, and we will try to touch on all of them in this class.

Constructing clear messages



Use simple language:

There is always the temptation to use your dictionary to look up "big" words or impressive sounding words so you can sound more intellectual. But, as a speaker, you should keep your message simple. Don't try to take a simple concept and make it complex.

Your audience needs you to sound relatable. When you elevate your language simply for the sake of using big words when small words are just as applicable, audiences may perceive you as insincere, and that perception might also transfer onto your message. In addition, the audience's attention can drift to questions about your character and veracity, making it less likely that they are paying attention to your message.

Also, if your audience can't understand your vocabulary, they can't understand your message.

Constructing clear messages

Use specific and precise language:

How many times have you gotten into an argument because of a word, maybe you told your friend you would call later, and later for you meant 2 days, and the person thought you meant 2 hours?

Language can be abstract. Meanings exist in people's understandings even beyond the words we use. f you do not use concrete language, you risk at least sending a weaker or different message than you intended.

When you are preparing your speech, look out for words that you might need to define more clearly. Imagine how different words could be misinterpreted and try to clarify them in your preparation and speech. The more precise you are the less likely it is that your audience will misinterpret your message.

Also, try to avoid using industry jargon and specific slang.

Using humor in public speaking

Many speakers like to use humour in their speeches to keep the audience engaged and the tone more light-hearted. While humour can be a very effective tool for keeping an audience engaged, it can also be problematic, especially when dealing with cultural issues. Here is a list of issues to consider when incorporating humour into a speech.

- Each culture has its own style of humour
- Humour requires exceptional knowledge of a language.
- Ethnic-type humour, stereotyping, and sexist, off-colour, cultural, or religious humour should generally be avoided
- Knowing the type of humour your audience appreciates can
- guide you
- When in doubt, the safest approach is to avoid humour.

Avoiding some language pitfalls



- Avoid profanity, using swear words or cuss words.
- Be very careful about exaggeration (words like always and never should be used as little as possible)
- Be careful for "powerless language" that make you look uncertain or not confident: "It seems that…", "I think that…"
- Ensure you only use correct grammar: avoid common errors, mispronunciations, pidgin, region-specific language

ETHICS IN PUBLIC SPEAKING

In conclusion…

Ethical considerations

You've made it this far, well done!

As we come to the end of this course, after covering the different elements of public speaking, the we will then explore the ethics of public speaking.

Ethics refers to what is right or moral.

Tips for ethical speaking

- Be honest and avoid plagiarism
- Identify your sources
- Know when to cite information and cite appropriately (see next slide)
- Promote diversity: one simple way of promoting diversity is to use both sexes in your hypothetical examples and to include co-cultural groups when creating a hypothetical situation
- Strive to break stereotypes: For instance, if you're telling a hypothetical story about a top surgeon in the nation, why not make the specialized surgeon a female from a rural area?
- Use inclusive language: avoid sexist language, for example talking about cooking and saying "the women know what I'm talking about".
- Avoid hate speech: don't speak in a derogatory manner about any person or group of people

When to cite:

- Words or ideas presented in a magazine, book, newspaper, song, TV program, movie, Web page, computer program, letter, advertisement, or any other medium.
- Information you gain through interviewing or conversing with another person, face to face, over the phone, or in writing.
- When you copy the exact words or a unique phrase.
- When you reprint any diagrams, illustrations, charts, pictures, or other visual materials
- When you reuse or repost any electronically available media, including images, audio, video, or other media.

When not to cite:

- Sharing your own lived experiences, your own observations and insights, your own thoughts, and your own conclusions about a subject.
- When you are sharing up your own results obtained through lab or field experiments.
- When you use your own artwork, digital photographs, video, audio, etc.
- When you are using common knowledge—things like folklore, common sense observations, myths, urban legends, and historical events (but not historical documents).
- When you are using generally accepted facts, e.g. pollution is bad for the environment.

ANY QUESTIONS?

